

Layer 0 Glossary - Every Fancy Word, Kid-Plain

If a word shows up anywhere in the study pack, it must be here. Kid line first (elementary). Strict line second (clearance-accurate). No tribal leftovers. Missing word = bug in this doc, not in you.

Source: Master glossary for Action OS / Gate. Read before 01-17. Replaces thin atom sheets.

How to use

1) Read the kid line out loud. 2) Check the strict line. 3) Give the example from memory. If you need another Gate word to explain it, that other word is not owned yet - look it up here first.

Story seed: A computer can press 'send money.' That does not mean it is allowed. Some sends cannot be undone like taking back a spilled cup of juice. Gate is the grown-up at the door who says stop or go - and keeps a note a stranger can read.

A. The world (before company words)

change

Kid: Something is different than before.

Strict: A state transition in the world or in a system.

Example: Account had \$10. Now it has \$0.

act / write

Kid: A specific thing the computer tries to do that changes the world.

Strict: A concrete operation that mutates state - especially money leave, bind, release.

Example: Clicking 'release payout' / POST that sends the wire.

side effect

Kid: The real-world leftover of an act - not just words on a screen.

Strict: An observable external consequence of executing a write.

Example: Money left the account; a policy became bound.

reversible

Kid: You can undo it easily, like erasing pencil.

Strict: Change can be cheaply and fully undone.

Example: Editing a draft email you never sent.

irreversible

Kid: You cannot undo it easily. The juice already spilled.

Strict: Change cannot be cheaply/fully undone; cost of reverse is high or impossible.

Example: Wire already sent. Peg out. Bind issued. Harm done.

irreversibility

Kid: The property of being one-way / hard to undo. The whole point of why we need a door.

Strict: The constraint class Gate sits on: acts whose completion has lasting, hard-to-reverse effects.

Example: Once money left, 'sorry' does not put it back for free.

finality

Kid: The moment the change is basically done-for-real.

Strict: The commit point after which the write is treated as completed/settled.

Example: Payment credited; transfer finished.

effectuation

Kid: The exact moment the system actually makes the irreversible thing happen.

Strict: The boundary where clearance must still be real as the write completes.

Example: Right before the wire fires - not yesterday's green sticker.

permission

Kid: Allowed - not just possible.

Strict: Normative authorization under live authority, policy, and proof.

authority

Kid: Who/what is allowed to say the path is on or off.

Strict: The controlling power that can grant or revoke may for a path.

policy

Kid: The rules that say what is allowed.

Strict: Machine-checkable constraints (caps, counterparties, intents) on a write.

proof

Kid: Something another kid can check - not 'because I said so.'

Strict: Evidence a third party can verify without trusting your narrative alone.

receipt

Kid: A note of what was decided or stopped.

Strict: Checkable record of a decision/halt bound to what was asked.

invariant

Kid: A rule that must always stay true - like 'never leave the stove on.'

Strict: A property that must hold on every path (e.g. write_executed false on Gate clearance).

B. Can vs may

can

Kid: Able to do it. The button works. The keys exist.

Strict: Capability: the system is able to perform the write.

Example: Payroll software can wire everyone today.

may

Kid: Allowed to do it right now under the rules.

Strict: Permission: write may complete under live authority, policy, and proof.

Example: Only this payout, this person, this approval, now.

can != may

Kid: Able is not allowed. Biggest law in kid words.

Strict: Ability is not permission. Diligence finds where can still completes without may.

justified

Kid: There is a good enough reason under the rules - not a vibe.

Strict: Epistemic/policy adequacy to allow irreversible commitment.

bypass

Kid: A sneaky second door that skips the stop sign.

Strict: Any alternate path that completes the write without the mouth's permit.

Example: Admin UI that pays while Gate says DEAD.

C. Stop / go words

DENY

Kid: STOP. The dangerous send must not finish. Money stays.

Strict: The irreversible write must not complete; the path halts with no quiet success. Not a mood; not a badge with another door open.

Example: Payout refused; receipt shows the halt.

HOLD

Kid: Pause. Wait for a grown-up check. Not yes.

Strict: Defer completion pending review; write does not complete while HOLD is in force.

ALLOW / GO / ACT (signal yes)

Kid: Conditions look okay to proceed - still not the same as money already gone.

Strict: Permission signal that path may proceed under current checks; distinct from execution.

NO_GO

Kid: Prefinality's hard no - do not sign/send.

Strict: Evaluate decision: fail closed; do not commit the transfer.

BLOCK

Kid: Velaru-style: proof rail says no / blocked.

Strict: Proof/fuse rail refusal (ALLOW/BLOCK language on Velaru).

halt

Kid: Stop this path now.

Strict: Abort processing of the write path; typically paired with DENY under uncertainty/refusal.

fail-closed

Kid: If unsure or broken: STOP. Never guess yes.

Strict: Uncertainty/timeout/missing proof => DENY/halt. Unreachable is not LIVE.

Example: *Velaru silent -> stop write.*

fail-open

Kid: If unsure: let it through (dangerous for money).

Strict: Uncertainty treated as allow - the failure mode Gate refuses.

soft-yes

Kid: Fake yes from panic, manners, or a broken check.

Strict: Treating politeness/panic/broken verification as permission.

UNREACHABLE

Kid: We could not talk to the checker - so we STOP, we do not invent LIVE.

Strict: Upstream/timeout state that must fail closed.

D. On/off authority

LIVE

Kid: The switch is ON for this path.

Strict: Fuse/authority currently on; write may be considered under mouth rules.

DEAD

Kid: The switch is OFF. Dangerous send must not finish.

Strict: Fuse/authority off; irreversible write must not complete.

CHARGE

Kid: The only special key that turns OFF back to ON.

Strict: Sole allowed regime-change DEAD -> LIVE. Not dashboard flip. Not Slack okay.

fuse

Kid: The ON/OFF object you check before acting.

Strict: Authority object hopped/looked up for LIVE/DEAD/verdict.

hop

Kid: Ask the fuse right now: are we LIVE?

Strict: A check/request against the fuse engine for current verdict/state.

verdict

Kid: The yes/no answer from the fuse check.

Strict: Boolean/result from hop used in clearance decisions.

quorum

Kid: More than one required yes - not one buddy alone.

Strict: Structured multi-party/policy requirement for LIVE; not charismatic single key.

webhook

Kid: A computer calls your computer when something happens (like CHARGE arrives).

Strict: HTTP callback delivering an event to your system.

E. Saying yes vs doing the thing

clearance

Kid: Permission check: 'Are we allowed right now?'

Strict: Decision that the write may proceed; not the write itself.

execution

Kid: Actually doing the irreversible thing.

Strict: Performing the write (money moves, bind commits, release fires).

clearance != execution

Kid: Teacher saying 'you may leave' is not the same as you already left the building.

Strict: Gate may permit; exclusive edge executes. `write_executed` false on Gate clearance.

write_executed

Kid: Flag: the irreversible thing really ran.

Strict: Boolean that the side effect completed. Must stay false on Gate clearance path.

acted / clearance_allows

Kid: Gate's 'you may proceed' signal - still not money gone.

Strict: Clearance permit fields; must not be confused with write_executed.

mouth

Kid: The door between 'can' and 'may' on the dangerous act.

Strict: Permission seat on the irreversible write.

exclusive edge / exclusive door

Kid: The only door allowed to do the real send after permit.

Strict: Single non-bypassable execution path after valid clearance.

weld

Kid: Bolting that exclusive door onto a real path so it cannot be skipped.

Strict: Binding the mouth onto a concrete irreversible write path with no side door.

worker (Cloudflare worker)

Kid: A tiny program that stands in front of the real website/action and checks Gate first.

Strict: Edge compute that asks /v1/act before fetch/origin; may set write-executed after success.

origin

Kid: The real place that does the action after the door says okay.

Strict: Upstream service/request that performs the side effect after permit.

F. Clear, Prefinality, reconstruct

Clear

Kid: At the important moment, permission is real and checkable - not a sticker.

Strict: At effectuation: proof reconstructs as presented AND authority is LIVE.

reconstruct

Kid: A stranger can rebuild and check the proof.

Strict: Independent rebuild/verify of presented evidence; required for Clear.

Clear <=> reconstruct

Kid: If you cannot rebuild it, it is not Clear.

Strict: Biconditional: Clear iff reconstructable presented proof AND LIVE.

Prefinality

Kid: Check GO/NO_GO before the irreversible finish line.

Strict: Doctrine/machinery inside Gate: evaluate before finality; not a sister company.

PRI (pre-irreversibility inhibition)

Kid: Build the STOP into the machine before the one-way act finishes.

Strict: Architectural restraint: execute iff LIVE and justified; else DENY; CHARGE-only reopen.

evaluate

Kid: Ask Prefinality for GO/NO_GO/HOLD on this transfer.

Strict: API/function that returns decision + receipt bound to transfer fingerprint.

verify

Kid: Check that a receipt/proof is real and still valid.

Strict: Validation path for receipt/JWT/fuse proof a stranger can use.

fingerprint

Kid: A unique stamp of exactly which write was approved.

Strict: Hash over canonical fields of the write/transfer so tickets cannot authorize a different act.

JWT / signed receipt

Kid: A sealed note the computer signed so others can check it was not forged.

Strict: Cryptographically signed token/receipt bound to decision + fingerprint + expiry.

TTL

Kid: Time limit - after that, the ticket/note is too old.

Strict: Time-to-live; expired grants must not spend.

rail

Kid: Which payment/transfer track (like different train lines).

Strict: Adapter class for finality (e.g. x402 agent wallet, rtp instant fiat).

x402

Kid: A rail where an agent wallet might sign - check before sign.

Strict: Prefinality adapter: before_wallet_sign style hook.

RTP / instant fiat rail

Kid: Fast bank-like credit path - check before the payment order.

Strict: Prefinality adapter before payment_order / FedNow-class credit.

mandate

Kid: The rules packet for this transfer (caps, expected payee, etc.).

Strict: Policy inputs to evaluate (max_amount, expected counterparty, ceilings).

G. Married write / tickets

married write

Kid: Permission glued to one exact action - not a free pass for anything.

Strict: Authorization bound to one spend fingerprint (method+path+job+kind).

ticket

Kid: A short, one-time permission slip for that exact action.

Strict: Short-lived single-use grant redeemable only for the fingerprinted write.

redeem

Kid: Use up the ticket while showing the same action.

Strict: Atomic consume of ticket presenting matching write; fail closed on mismatch/replay/stale.

single-use

Kid: One time only. Replay is cheating.

Strict: Ticket cannot be successfully redeemed twice.

stale hop / museum hop

Kid: An old 'yes' that can no longer spend - like yesterday's hall pass.

Strict: Prior LIVE/hop without fresh ticket cannot authorize spend; demo/old hop is museum.

museum

Kid: Looks real, cannot authorize the live dangerous send anymore.

Strict: Demo or expired hop/proof without spend power.

TOCTOU (time gap bug) - plain

Kid: Checked okay at time A, did something else dangerous at time B.

Strict: Time-of-check to time-of-use gap; married tickets exist to close it.

license fuse / parent LIVE

Kid: If the parent permission dies, kids cannot outlive it.

Strict: Parent authority must be LIVE; children_cannot_outlive_parent.

H. Company / family / honesty

Nisaba / Action OS

Kid: The company that sits on permission for irreversible acts.

Strict: Firm whose scarcity is DENY that holds + stranger-openable receipt - not narrative.

Gate

Kid: The mouth: does the irreversible write complete?

Strict: Clearance mouth (/v1/act, CHARGE, weld) - clearance not execution.

Erra

Kid: Should we act? Signal ACT/HOLD.

Strict: Signal rail in the family map.

Velaru

Kid: Did we commit correctly? Proof ALLOW/BLOCK + fuse/verify.

Strict: Proof rail; stranger verify surface.

Verra

Kid: Did both rails clear before bind?

Strict: Action-session rail.

Mishara

Kid: Was a person harmed?

Strict: Consumer harm path rail.

scarcity (Nisaba)

Kid: The valuable thing is a real STOP that holds - not a speech.

Strict: Product scarcity = DENY/DEAD that holds, not storytelling.

stranger-openable

Kid: Someone outside your team can open the proof.

Strict: Verification without logging into your narrative/trust boundary.

their_production

Kid: Honesty bit: only true when a real customer's path is exclusively welded.

Strict: False until third-party exclusive production weld recorded; demos stay demos.

dogfood

Kid: You try your own product on yourself first.

Strict: First-party weld/record that lifts readiness but does not flip their_production.

cosplay

Kid: Dressing up like production/clearance without the real door.

Strict: Claiming force/production/contracts without weld/receipts.

Tier-S / coordinators

Kid: Highest serious continuity rooms - we contribute mouth, we do not own their guns.

Strict: Contribution altitude under global coordinators; no monopoly ownership claims.

C2

Kid: Command-and-control of force systems - state monopoly; we are not that.

Strict: Military/state command layer; out of ownership scope.

driver node vs hub

Kid: Hold the real lever on the act - not the busy billboard.

Strict: Controllability: weld irreversible edges; hub dashboards are not drivers.

I. Money faces / SKUs

SKU

Kid: A named thing you sell with a price.

Strict: Sellable product unit.

diligence

Kid: Paid homework: find where dangerous sends can still happen without may.

Strict: \$2,500 deposit SKU - written may-gap find; not a weld.

deposit / DEPOSIT ask

Kid: Money due now to start the paid find.

Strict: Upfront payment that triggers diligence delivery clock.

Bind Room

Kid: Paid pack of examiner papers + halt proof links.

Strict: \$1,750 SKU - officer pack + stranger-openable halt appendix; not a weld.

operator / register

Kid: Human doors to commit/weld or register infrastructure fees.

Strict: Surfaces for weld checkout and non-SaaS fee registration.

bps

Kid: Tiny fee slices (basis points) - pricing for authority dissipation, not SaaS seats.

Strict: Basis points on flow; infrastructure fee framing.

Clear (quit trigger sense)

Kid: Paid diligence or Bind money that actually cleared - not a polite reply.

Strict: External receipt of paid SKU; replies are not Clear.

J. Computer words used in the pack

API

Kid: A menu of things one computer lets another computer ask for.

Strict: Application programming interface - machine-callable operations.

HTTP

Kid: How browsers/servers send asks and answers.

Strict: Request/response protocol on the web.

GET

Kid: Please show/read this.

Strict: HTTP method for read/retrieve.

POST

Kid: Please do/submit this change.

Strict: HTTP method often used to submit/act.

URL / endpoint / route

Kid: The address of a specific door on the server.

Strict: Path that maps to handler code (/v1/act, /diligence).

JSON

Kid: Structured text computers exchange - keys and values.

Strict: Data format for API bodies.

environment variable

Kid: Secret/settings kept outside the code (keys, public URL).

Strict: Process config/secrets injection; never commit live secrets.

DNS

Kid: Phone book from name to computer address.

Strict: Domain name resolution.

timeout

Kid: Waited too long - treat as broken, fail closed.

Strict: Exceeded wait bound; must not become soft LIVE.

5xx / 4xx / 2xx

Kid: Server broken / you asked wrong / mostly okay.

Strict: HTTP status classes.

PII

Kid: Personal private person info - Gate should refuse holding it on PAS paths.

Strict: Personally identifiable information.

PAS

Kid: Gate's bind/authority paths (policy action side) - still fail closed; no PII dump.

Strict: Product/action surface namespace for bind-ticket style controls.

SPF / DKIM / DMARC

Kid: Email authenticity locks so others cannot easily forge your From address.

Strict: DNS email authentication suite for outbound trust.

K. Bind Room buyer dialect (SKU words - not Layer-0 physics)

These appear in doc 08. They are insurance/compliance shop words. Learn them as buyer language after atoms - they are not the physics of DENY.

SERFF

Kid: A filing system insurers use to submit docs to regulators.

Strict: System for Electronic Rates & Forms Filing - shapes officer pack length/format talk.

NYDFS

Kid: New York financial regulator letters/rules buyers cite.

Strict: NY Department of Financial Services circulars (e.g. board oversight expectations).

ECDIS

Kid: Their phrase for algorithms/tools that can discriminate if badly governed.

Strict: Buyer vocabulary in Section 5 governing principles text.

PolicyCenter

Kid: A common insurance system where bind/issue writes happen.

Strict: Guidewire-class policy admin; hop-before-bind story lives here.

CUO

Kid: Chief Underwriting Officer - senior insurance buyer/exam audience.

Strict: Title often receiving Bind Room packaging.

officer pack / appendix B

Kid: Short official booklet + on-request list of verify links per bind event.

Strict: Bind Room artifact pair examiners take.

L. Elementary teach-back (pass/fail)

- What is irreversibility? (one-way / hard to undo)
- What is DENY? (dangerous send must not finish)
- What is can vs may?
- What is clearance vs execution?
- What is Clear? (rebuildable proof + still LIVE at the moment)
- What is a ticket vs a hop?
- What is their_production?
- Pick any fancy word from another PDF and find it here. If missing, that is a bug - tell the agent.

M. Missing-word rule

This glossary is supposed to be complete for the study pack. If you meet a technical/fancy word not defined here, stop. Do not guess from vibes. Add it here before continuing. Layer 0 means no mishaps.